The central governance body needs to clearly distinguish what tools it wants to support centrally, using, for example, the economy of scale, to ensure cost-effectiveness, or to avoid problems with compatibility. Within this category, the body should again distinguish what tool will be mandatory to use by all development teams (and limit this list to a required minimum) and what sets of tools serving similar purposes could be offered as a selection list.

The central governance body could decide on a cloud infrastructure provider (if the governance body negotiated preferential prices), or on a logging solution (to simplify maintenance of a critical functionality). For codebase maintainability, central governance could also decide to limit a list of tools for, for example, event processing.

The tools not requiring central support nor affecting the interoperability of the teams should be left at the discretion of data product owners.

6.3.3 Tactical-level outcomes

Tactical-level governance means ensuring the feasibility of the proposed solutions. The strategic level of data governance focuses on doing the right things, whereas tactical-level governance focuses on doing things right. To ensure that your data governance does not end with the publication of policies, you need to discuss at least two critical topics: nonfunctional requirements of policies and data responsibilities.

DETAILING POLICIES

Designing a policy that can be implemented requires a good knowledge of the environment. Let’s take as an example a policy related to data security.

We could think that a policy requiring biometric scanning as an authentication method for access to the company’s laptops would increase the safety of data. Let’s assume that such a solution would indeed increase security, but what if most of the company’s equipment is not equipped with the required scanners? Maybe updating the personnel’s equipment would be a good idea anyway (if it’s obsolete and slows all company’s operations), or